The General Theory of Finite Obstruction Calculus

Jeremy H. Carroll

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Publication Main

All files are available open source at:

`https://github.com/dbccpage/general_theory_of_finite_obstruction_calculus`

This file is the publication-facing spine extracted from the working tome. Full proofs are in `2_GTFOC_Proof_Archive.md`.

LLM, Kaggle, domain, quantum, and miscellaneous workbench material is kept in `4_GTFOC_Tertiary_Workbench.md`.

Reader's Guide

Finite Obstruction Calculus (FOC) is the finite mathematical engine that evaluates a certified regime by representing defects in a finite cochain complex, quotienting out exact repairs, measuring residual obstruction, and classifying the result as exact, survivor, open, lift-required, refused, or otherwise terminalized. The main paper keeps only the finite obstruction core: realization packet, cochain complex, Q^1, Φ, H^1, closure trichotomy, observer passivity, context-witness lift trigger, minimal resolver, and no-silent-mutation laws. The proof archive preserves the full proof text. The tertiary workbench keeps applications, implementation ledgers, toy models, speculative extensions, and external bridges out of the publication spine.

Abstract

We formalize a finite obstruction-repair calculus for contextual symbolic systems. A level is a finite tuple

$$\mathcal{M} = (\mathcal{T}, \mathcal{C}, \rho, C^\bullet, \omega, p)$$

where $\mathcal{T}$ and $\mathcal{C}$ are finite categories, $\rho : \mathcal{C} \to \mathrm{End}(\mathcal{T})$ is a context action, and

$$C^0 \xrightarrow{d_0} C^1 \xrightarrow{d_1} C^2, \qquad d_1 d_0 = 0$$

is a finite cochain complex. Exact repairs form $B^1 = \mathrm{im}(d_0)$; quotient obstruction is

$$Q^1 = C^1/B^1;$$

and closed residual obstruction is

$$H^1 = \ker(\bar{d}_1) \cong \ker(d_1)/\,\mathrm{im}(d_0).$$

A declared finite gauge gives a quotient obstruction magnitude Φ. Context-visible non-congruence supplies the lift trigger. Licensed lifts require explicit witness, resolver, minimality, preservation, and no-silent-mutation certificates.

Non-Claims

This theory does not claim that every truth is finite. It does not claim that every obstruction is physical, cognitive, quantum, analytic, or metaphysical. It does not claim that a positive obstruction mass automatically licenses a lift. It does not claim Langlands, zeta, quantum-information, continuum, consciousness, or empirical-world consequences without a separate finite descent/certificate path.

The narrow claim is:

Narrow claim: finite obstruction authority requires finite realization, quotient obstruction, certificates, and terminal/refusal semantics.

1 Synchronization with Finite Authority Systems

The finite obstruction calculus is the local verifier inside the Finite Authority System arena. In the global authority pipeline,

$$\mathcal{C}_0 \xrightarrow{\mathcal{R}} \mathcal{C} \xrightarrow{\rho} \mathcal{S} \xrightarrow{D} \mathcal{P} \xrightarrow{V} \mathbb{V} \xrightarrow{\tau} \mathbb{T},$$

this monograph supplies the internal logic of the transition

$$D \to \mathbb{V} \to \mathbb{T}.$$

No claim in this calculus has theorem-grade or authority-grade status unless it is coupled to a finite realization packet and replayable certificate.

2 Primitive Distinguishability

Axiom 2.1 (T0)**.** Distinguishability is primitive. Sameness is certified zero-difference inside a declared difference regime.

For a declared difference detector δ,

$$a = b \iff \delta(a, b) = 0.$$

The zero has meaning only because the difference detector exists. Thus exactness is not absence of structure; it is certified absorption by a declared repair image.

3 Finite Realization Gate

A theorem-grade claim X in the finite obstruction calculus requires a declared finite realization packet

$$\mathcal{G} = (K, \mathcal{C}, \rho, C^\bullet, E, \mathcal{O}, V, \tau, \mathcal{K}, \Lambda)$$

where

$$C^\bullet : C^0 \xrightarrow{d_0} C^1 \xrightarrow{d_1} C^2, \qquad d_1 d_0 = 0.$$

The gate theorem is:

$$\boxed{\mathsf{TheoremGrade}(X) \Rightarrow K \wedge (\mathcal{C}, \rho) \wedge C^\bullet \wedge E \wedge \mathcal{O} \wedge V \wedge \tau \wedge \mathcal{K} \wedge \Lambda.}$$

Equivalently, absence of any required component gives a typed realization/refusal terminal, not a proof of falsity.

4 Ambient Finite Core

Let

$$\mathsf{FinCat}, \qquad \mathsf{FinSet}, \qquad \mathsf{Vect}_{\mathbb{R}}^{fd}$$

denote finite small categories, finite sets, and finite-dimensional real vector spaces.

For a finite category $\mathcal{C}$,

$$\widehat{\mathcal{C}}_{fin} = \mathsf{FinSet}^{\mathcal{C}^{op}}$$

is the finite presheaf environment. If a finite Grothendieck topology J is explicitly supplied, one may form

$$\mathsf{Sh}(\mathcal{C}, J) \subseteq \widehat{\mathcal{C}}_{fin}.$$

No sheaf topology is automatic.

5 MSS-N Level

An MSS level is a finite tuple

$$\mathcal{M}_n = (\mathcal{T}_n, \mathcal{C}_n, \rho_n, L_n, D_n, O_n, \delta_n, \chi_n, \omega_n, \mu_n)$$

where $\mathcal{T}_n$ is a finite term/state category, $\mathcal{C}_n$ is a finite admissible context category, $\rho_n : \mathcal{C}_n \to \mathsf{End}(\mathcal{T}_n)$ is a context action, L_n is the repair generator set, D_n is the distinction-coordinate set, O_n is the closure/obstruction-coordinate set, and ω_n is a declared positive gauge.

The cochain carrier is

$$C_n^0 = \mathbb{R}^{L_n}, \qquad C_n^1 = \mathbb{R}^{D_n}, \qquad C_n^2 = \mathbb{R}^{O_n},$$

with

$$d_{0,n} = \delta_n, \qquad d_{1,n} = \chi_n, \qquad d_{1,n} d_{0,n} = 0.$$

6 Defects, Exact Repair, and Quotient Obstruction

For a submitted finite state s, an edge defect has the form

$$\delta_e(s) = r_e(s(v)) - s(u).$$

The exact repair subspace is

$$B_n^1 = \mathrm{im}(d_{0,n}) \subseteq C_n^1.$$

The quotient obstruction space is

$$Q_n^1 = C_n^1 / B_n^1, \qquad \pi_n : C_n^1 \to Q_n^1.$$

Because $d_{1,n}d_{0,n} = 0$, $d_{1,n}$ descends to

$$\bar{d}_{1,n} : Q^1_n \to C^2_n, \qquad \bar{d}_{1,n}\pi_n = d_{1,n}.$$

The closed quotient sector is

$$H^1_n = \ker(\bar{d}_{1,n}) \cong \ker(d_{1,n})/\operatorname{im}(d_{0,n}).$$

Elements of $H^1_n \setminus \{0\}$ are closed non-exact residual classes.

7 Normed Cokernel and Obstruction Magnitude

A positive weight system gives

$$\|x\|_{1,\omega_n} = \sum_{d \in D_n} \omega_{n,d}|x_d|.$$

The quotient obstruction norm is

$$\Phi_n([x]) = \inf_{\alpha \in C^0_n} \|x - d_{0,n}\alpha\|_{1,\omega_n}.$$

The closure mass is

$$\Gamma_n([x]) = \|\bar{d}_{1,n}([x])\|.$$

Safe norm principle: independent finite defects add by outer ℓ^1 after local gauges are declared.

Local gauges may be scalar ℓ^1, vector ℓ^2, trace norm, or another declared finite gauge. The core does not assert that ℓ^1 is universal.

8 Main Theorems

Theorem 8.1 (T1 — Finite Realization Gate)**.** *No theorem-grade finite obstruction claim exists without a finite realization packet*

$$(K, \mathcal{C}, \rho, C^\bullet, E, \mathcal{O}, V, \tau, \mathcal{K}, \Lambda).$$

The failed claim is not false by default; it terminalizes as a missing-carrier, missing-context, missing-complex, missing-operator, missing-evaluator, missing-certificate, or missing-refusal-semantics condition.

Theorem 8.2 (T2 — Normed Cokernel and Quotient Obstruction)**.** *Let*

$$C^0 \xrightarrow{d_0} C^1 \xrightarrow{d_1} C^2$$

be a finite-dimensional real cochain complex with $d_1 d_0 = 0$. Let C^1 carry a declared norm. Define

$$B^1 = \operatorname{im}(d_0), \qquad Q^1 = C^1/B^1,$$

and

$$\Phi([x]) = \inf_{\alpha \in C^0} \|x - d_0\alpha\|.$$

Then Q^1 is the cokernel of d_0, Φ is the quotient norm on Q^1, the infimum is attained, d_1 descends to $\bar{d}_1 : Q^1 \to C^2$, and

$$H^1 = \ker(\bar{d}_1) \cong \ker(d_1)/\operatorname{im}(d_0).$$

Theorem 8.3 (T3 — Primal-Dual Certificate Identity)**.** *For $d_0 : C^0 \to C^1 \cong \mathbb{R}^n$ and positive weights ω_i, define*

$$\Phi([x]) = \min_{\alpha \in C^0} \sum_i \omega_i |x_i - (d_0\alpha)_i|.$$

Then

$$\boxed{\Phi([x]) = \max_{\varphi \in (C^1)^*} \{\varphi(x) : d_0^*\varphi = 0,\ |\varphi_i| \le \omega_i\}.}$$

The primal minimum and dual maximum are attained. A replayable certificate consists of primal repair data, dual annihilator data, and a primal-dual equality check.

Theorem 8.4 (T4 — Context Witness Lift Trigger)**.** *Let $S = (\mathcal{T}, \mathcal{C}, \rho; C^\bullet, \omega, p)$ with*

$$p : \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{T}) \to Q^1.$$

Define

$$x \sim y \iff p(x) = p(y).$$

A lift is triggered only by context-visible non-congruence:

$$\boxed{\mathsf{LiftTrigger}(S) \iff \exists x, y, c : x \sim y \ \wedge\ \rho(c)x \not\sim \rho(c)y.}$$

Obstruction mass alone does not imply licensed lift:

$$\Phi(q) > 0 \not\Rightarrow \mathsf{LicensedLift}.$$

Theorem 8.5 (T5 — Minimal Resolver Existence)**.** *Let w be a typed context witness, and let $\mathcal{G}(w)$ be a declared finite candidate resolver class. If valid resolvers are decidable, nonempty, and ordered by a finite well-founded minimality order, then there exists a minimal valid resolver*

$$G^* \in \mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{vRes}}(w).$$

The theorem proves existence, not uniqueness. If incomparable minimal resolvers exist and no declared equivalence identifies them, the valid terminal is nonunique-minimality or refusal, not silent choice.

Theorem 8.6 (T6 — Generator Growth Law)**.** *If finite generators update by*

$$G_{n+1} = G_n \sqcup \coprod_{w \in W_n} \Delta_G(w),$$

with finite witness set W_n, then

$$\boxed{S(n+1) = S(n) + \sum_{w \in W_n} \Delta(w).}$$

Theorem 8.7 (T7 — Skeleton Preservation / No Silent Mutation)**.** *Let $F_n : \mathcal{M}_n \to \mathcal{M}_{n+1}$ be a licensed lift, and let $U_n : \mathcal{M}_{n+1} \to \mathcal{M}_n$ be its forgetful comparison. Define*

$$\mathsf{LF}_n = U_n F_n.$$

For certified old skeleton data $q \in \mathrm{Skel}_n$, preservation requires

$$\boxed{q \in \mathrm{Skel}_n \Rightarrow U_n F_n(q) = q.}$$

If $U_n F_n(q) \neq q$ without an explicit terminal tag declaring refinement, quotienting, invalidation, or refusal, then the lift commits silent mutation.

9 Closure Trichotomy

For $q \in Q_n^1$, define

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathsf{Exact}_n(q) &\iff \Phi_n(q) = 0, \\
\mathsf{Survivor}_n(q) &\iff \Phi_n(q) > 0 \wedge \bar{d}_{1,n}(q) = 0, \\
\mathsf{Open}_n(q) &\iff \Phi_n(q) > 0 \wedge \bar{d}_{1,n}(q) \neq 0.
\end{aligned}$$

Finite dimensionality gives the disjoint partition

$$Q_n^1 = \mathsf{Exact}_n \sqcup \mathsf{Survivor}_n \sqcup \mathsf{Open}_n.$$

A survivor is a closed non-exact quotient residual. An open obstruction is not yet structure; it requires repair, lift, refusal, or budget boundary.

10 Observers and Epistemic Quotients

An observer is a finite, deterministic, repair-compatible quotient map

$$\mathcal{O} : Q_n^1 \to Q_{\mathcal{O}}^1.$$

Observer quotients are epistemic structure. They erase or identify distinctions. They do not create obstruction.

Cross-observer stability is always relative to a declared finite observer family

$$\mathfrak{O}_n = \{\mathcal{O}_1, \ldots, \mathcal{O}_k\}.$$

A class is observer-invariant only relative to a proven observer class.

11 Terminal Semantics

A verified obstruction class terminalizes into one of the following schematic statuses:

Terminal	Meaning
Exact	zero obstruction under declared repair image
Survivor	closed non-exact residual
Open	nonzero obstruction with nonzero closure mass
LicensedLift	context witness plus valid lift contract
BudgetUnknown	finite budget exhausted without authority
NoRule	no declared rule licenses the move
TypedRefusal	claim falls outside the current authority regime

Non-exact obstruction never silently authorizes exactness.

12 Compact Formula Sheet

$$C^0 \xrightarrow{d_0} C^1 \xrightarrow{d_1} C^2, \qquad d_1 d_0 = 0.$$

$$B^1 = \mathrm{im}(d_0), \qquad Q^1 = C^1/B^1, \qquad \pi : C^1 \to Q^1.$$

$$\bar{d}_1([x]) = d_1 x.$$

$$H^1 = \ker(\bar{d}_1) \cong \ker(d_1)/\,\mathrm{im}(d_0).$$

$$\Phi([x]) = \inf_{\alpha \in C^0} \|x - d_0\alpha\|.$$

$$\Gamma([x]) = \|\bar{d}_1([x])\|.$$

$$x \sim y \iff p(x) = p(y).$$

Lift trigger: there exist finite objects x, y and a context c such that $x \sim y$ but $\rho(c)x \not\sim \rho(c)y$.

13 Minimal Theorem Statement

A finite contextual obstruction system has theorem-grade authority only after finite realization. Its exact repair classes form $B^1 = \mathrm{im}(d_0)$, its obstruction quotient is $Q^1 = C^1/B^1$, and its closed residual sector is $H^1 = \ker(\bar{d}_1)$. A positive obstruction class blocks exactness but does not by itself license lift. Lift requires context-visible non-congruence plus a finite resolver/lift contract. Any representation extension that changes certified skeleton data without explicit terminal tagging commits silent mutation.

14 Safe Claims

1. The finite obstruction core is a finite cochain complex with certified quotient obstruction.
2. Exactness is zero class in Q^1.
3. Closed non-exact residuals are nonzero elements of H^1.
4. Φ is a declared finite-gauge quotient norm, not a universal metaphysical norm.
5. Context-visible non-congruence is the core lift trigger.
6. Licensed lift requires witness, resolver, minimality, preservation, and replay certificates.
7. Observer quotients do not create obstruction.
8. Speculative bridges require separate finite descent packets.

15 Boundary

The finite obstruction calculus is expansive by extension, not by implication. New domains may be represented, reflected, or connected only after a finite realization and certificate path is supplied.